current political discourse, the decisive break in 1971, when the PRC replaced the ROC as the holder of the Security Council seat, is no longer highlighted. It is as if there is an eternal China for which these interruptions in history were mere episodes. We can clearly see how history is manipulated by China to serve its current political objectives.

While such attempts to rewrite history take place in every country, including, as we are currently witnessing, in India itself, the Chinese effort is much more deliberative and even dramatic. This propensity, to cut and paste history to serve its political objectives, keeps cropping up in China's current relations with the external world too.

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